

THIS IS WHERE IT'S AT

Serious Politics In *Second Life*

In case you've missed out on the news, politicians are flocking to the free realms of *Second Life*. John Edwards, one of the US presidential candidates, has set up his headquarters there. It won't be long before the others join the fray... even as we write this, there's probably some breaking news of someone new having set up court in the it's-now-getting-ridiculous *Second Life*.

Spanish politicians, meanwhile, are ahead of the game: the two main political parties in Spain were busy fighting last month's local elections in the true spirit of good politics by attempting to burn down each other's headquarters. Some gory details: the socialist government has accused the Partifo Popular party of bombs being thrown, the building having been

What's Next?

This little piece is usually the last thing we write for the magazine. After the month long battle called the *Anniversary Issue*, a lot of us are tired, sleepy and just dying to go home to our families. Seriously, it's no joke preparing this much more content in June with the same team strength as every other month.

While sitting around and chatting (boasting even) about the issue, the innovations that the different teams managed to pull off—marketing, design, editorial and distribution—we started wondering what next year would be like.

"Last year it was the *Power of 5*, this year it was the *Sixth Sense*. What will next year be?" asked a dozing FatBeing (Nimish). It's all we needed to start another informal brain storming

session. "Seven deadly sins?" opined Ram. "Ooh, I choose Gluttony," replied FatBeing. "I'll do Pride", came Asfaq's reply. "I could use a little Sloth", droned Raaabo. "I'm Lusting for a new system", quipped Michael.

This set the ball rolling and the comments got cornier. Samir and Rossi both wanted Greed, and started an argument, leaving Sanket and the Ed with a lot of Wrath.

There were mentions of Iron Maiden's *Seventh son of a seventh son*, and how could we forget the *Seven Wonders of the Technology World*, or someone's wise-crack about VII being the Indian spelling for Wii. Whatever we do for our next anniversary issue, we hope the current team won't suffer from the *Seven Year Itch* and leave!

DIGIT DIARY

entered with sub-machine guns, and arson having been committed. Partifo Popular says it had merely retaliated. "We have complained to the *Second Life* commission about the terrorism." There seems to be no letting up.

So it's come down to that. We gave you the details just so you could gather the very real idea that people with broadband are living *Second Lives*.

Politicians could be getting aboard *Second Life* so they can target younger voters better. Interesting, and very practical... But then most *Second Life* citizens probably don't have a first life, so they won't vote anyway. Then again, can we anticipate a country actually going online and elections being held and made official and all right within the game? *Sixth Sense* again!

Gamepolitics.com hosted a video report of one US candidate speaking out about *Second Life*. One statement went, "A candidate has no need to put up a flat Web page when they can create a... space." One Greg went thus in response: "No NEED? I think The Internet has a few more users than *Second Life* does, and is a bit more accessible."

For now, perhaps. ☒

Blog WATCH

All around the world are important people talking about the "Microhoo" possibility; even otherwise, it's Google, Microsoft, and Yahoo! all the way

Robert Scoble

"Fear of Google" now actually has a TLA!

<http://tinyurl.com/2a4zus>

<http://scobleizer.com/2007/05/06/fear-of-google/>
Fear of Google

Yesterday... Geoff Ramsey, CEO of eMarketer's funniest remark was when he told us that the "Fear of Google" was so prevalent that it even had a three-letter acronym: FOG. Anyway, I've been hearing more and more about FOG all weekend... Here's a few examples:

Why did the stock market drive shares of Yahoo! up so fast on total rumors that Microsoft was buying Yahoo!? Easy, we wanted it to happen. "We" being journalists who are living in FOG land. Bloggers who'd like to see Microsoft be interesting again... Several people on the boat were hoping that Microsoft would buy Yahoo! simply to keep competition going in the advertising market...

Wolfgang Gruener

<http://tinyurl.com/yuzdl9>

<http://www.tgdaily.com/content/view/31899/113/>
The UMPC dies. And no body notices.

...When Microsoft pitched a mysterious Origami device, which essentially became the concept and general understanding of what a UMPC should be,

we learned that the industry had a new device in mind created to cash in on the increasingly mobile and connected world: A device that may be purchased in addition to the notebook users already own, but small enough to fit in a small backpack or purse...

...The UMPC looks like it has hit dead end. To turn it around, there are two possible solutions: Correct the product design mistakes and offer a more tailored product to the mainstream market, or, ...

Greg Sterling

<http://tinyurl.com/3dzuw2>

<http://gesterling.wordpress.com/2007/05/18/two-networks-to-rule-them-all-us-and-google/>
Two Networks to Rule Them All: Us and Google

I just got off the phone with Joe Doran, General Manager, Microsoft Digital Advertising Solutions. Doran said, "We believe there will be two major ad delivery platforms at most..." By "platforms," he meant companies. I then asked who the other company was (assuming MSFT is one), he said that it was Google. Hmmm . . . does that mean that Yahoo!, still the largest site on the Internet, will gradually lose more and more share in his mind? Or does it mean Microsoft intends to acquire or merge with Yahoo! at some point?